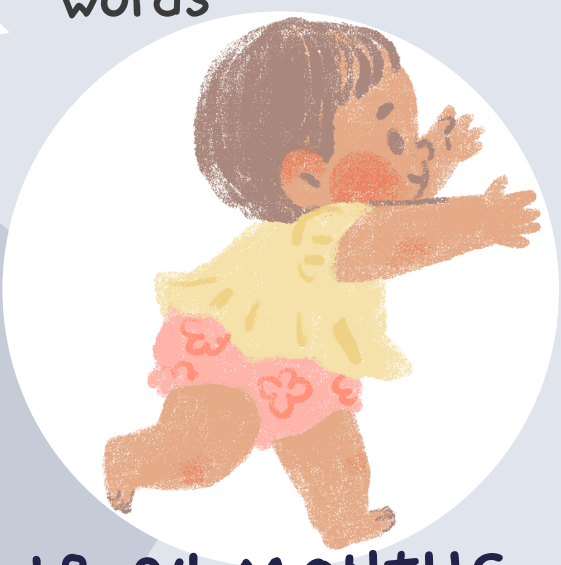
Speech and Language Milestones

BIRTH- 12 MONTHS

- Recognizes own name/familiar words
- Uses reduplicated babbling ("baba")
- Uses gestures and 1-2 words

12 -18 MONTHS

- Points to a few body parts
- Understands simple questions ("where's daddy?")
- Says 10- 50 words
- Imitates words frequently



18-24 MONTHS

- Points to pictures in books
- Follows 2-step related directions
- Recognizes many objects/people
- Combines 2 words together
- Produces between 50-300 words

24-36 MONTHS

- Follows 2-step unrelated directions
- Understands simple concepts (in/out, up/down)
- Uses 2-3 word phrases
- Produces between 200-1,000 words

3-4 YEARS

- Understands -Wh questions (what, where, who)
- Understands simple time concepts (soon, later
- Uses 4+ word sentences
- Speech intelligibility is ~75% intelligible to unfamiliar listeners

4-5 YEARS

- Understands complex sentences/stories
- Understands concepts (same/different)
- Uses detailed 5+ word sentences
- Speech is 90-100% intelligible